

Brazil macro: one conditional trade

Rates, the real and commodity exports

Fixed research snapshot: 2026-09-13T16:58:14-03:00 · EN

Rates favor the dollar; oil favors Brazil. USD/BRL near its recent low shows that the dollar case is not yet winning. Wait for a close above 5.22 with firm U.S. yields before considering the trade.

OBSERVED · SAVED DATA

USD/BRL PTAX midpoint 5.0915 BRL / USD 2026-09-11	Selic target 14.00 % 2026-09-13
Brazil-U.S. policy gap 10.375 pp 2026-09-13	U.S. two-year yield 4.56 % 2026-09-10

SCENARIOS · ASSUMPTIONS

Saved September 2026 cases, not forecasts with assigned probabilities. The base case reflects the saved pricing anchors; FX effects are conditional, all else equal. An expected decision alone is not a new trading edge.

Hawkish relative to expectations

Copom: Hold 14.00%; restrictive bias · FOMC: Hold 3.50%-3.75%; firm guidance

Likely unchanged near 10.38 pp · Likely BRL strength / USD-BRL lower

Evidence to watch: PTAX below 5.08 with US 2Y lower

Base case

Copom: Cut 25 bp to 13.75%; cautious · FOMC: Hike 25 bp to 3.75%-4.00%; data-dependent

Likely narrows 50 bp to 9.88 pp · Likely BRL weakness / USD-BRL higher

Evidence to watch: PTAX above 5.22 with US 2Y near 4.56%

Dovish relative to expectations

Copom: Cut 50 bp to 13.50%; easing bias · FOMC: Hike 25 bp to 3.75%-4.00%; firm bias

Likely narrows 75 bp to 9.63 pp · Likely BRL weakness / USD-BRL higher

Evidence to watch: PTAX above 5.22 with US 2Y above 4.56%

PAPER TRADE · CONDITIONAL RULES

No position at the saved snapshot; subsequent activation is not monitored.

Rates and oil point in opposite directions. Higher US yields and a potentially smaller Brazil-US rate gap favor the dollar, while oil above USD 100 can support Brazil's export income and the real. USD/BRL near its recent low shows that the dollar case is not yet winning, so the trade requires a confirmed break above 5.22.

Entry / confirmation

No position at the 5.0915 snapshot. Consider the paper trade only after a daily PTAX midpoint closes above approximately 5.22, the rounded high of the refreshed 20-observation range (5.2233), with the US 2-year yield still near or above 4.56% or the policy differential actually narrowing.

Invalidation / after entry

Before entry, abandon the dollar thesis if PTAX closes below approximately 5.08 while oil remains firm. After entry, invalidate on two consecutive daily midpoints below approximately 5.15, the rounded midpoint of the refreshed range (5.1543), or if the rate gap fails to narrow and export flows continue to support the real.

Review zone / not a target

Add the refreshed 20-observation high (5.2233) to its width (0.1380) to obtain 5.3613; use 5.36-5.37 only as a review zone and reassess sooner if US yields fall or commodity support for the real strengthens.

Catalyst / timing

Both meetings run on 15-16 September 2026; decisions are scheduled for 16 September. Reassess the idea after the announcements and their guidance.

Main risks: oil and export income keep supporting the real; Brazil preserves its rate advantage; U.S. yields fall; or Brazilian fiscal and election news attracts capital. The oil shock can support exports while also raising global inflation and risk aversion.

PTAX is an official daily reference, not a live or executable spot quote. Levels are rounded research rules; 5.22 is slightly below the exact saved high of 5.2233. Costs, slippage and position sizing are not modelled.

COMMODITIES · A CROSS-CHECK

Oil · 109.51 USD / barrel · +3.2%

2026-09-09 / compared with 2026-09-08 · EIA / FRED

Oil can lift export income but also fuel inflation.

Iron ore · 101.60 USD / tonne · -2.1%

2026-07 / compared with 2026-06 · IMF / FRED

Iron ore connects export receipts to steel demand, especially in China.

Soybeans · 426.33 USD / tonne · +4.9%

Q2 2026 / compared with Q1 2026 · IMF / FRED

Soybeans bring export dollars; harvest timing and demand shape flows.

Sugar · 14.81 US cents / lb · +6.5%

2026-07 / compared with 2026-06 · IMF / FRED

Sugar competes with ethanol for cane, linking exports to fuel economics.

METHOD AND SOURCE LIMITS

Focus is a survey, not a policy commitment. The policy gap subtracts the Fed target-range midpoint from Selic; it is not an investment return. Commodity prices have different observation periods. The PDF is generated from saved files and does not update automatically.

Research horizon: approximately two to four weeks around the September meetings. The base case supports the idea; the more restrictive relative-rate case invalidates it.

B3: 1 September 2026; about 21.8 basis points of easing estimated from DI futures, not a published Copom probability. CME: 1 September 2026, 02:07 CT; the final refresh failed. These saved inputs are not current pricing. No joint probability is assigned.

USD/BRL changed -0.72% over approximately one month. A fall means the real strengthened; higher U.S. yields have not yet dominated oil and export support.

Hawkish relative to expectations

A global risk-off or commodity shock could weaken BRL even with a more favorable relative-rate outcome.

Base case

The paired moves may already be reflected in rates and FX, leaving global risk appetite, commodities or fiscal news as the dominant driver.

Dovish relative to expectations

A larger Copom cut could be read as a credibility error, lifting local risk premia and front-end rates rather than producing the assumed orderly easing reaction.

The U.S. two-year yield rose 0.31 percentage point over one month to 4.56%, a dollar-positive signal.

Yet USD/BRL fell 0.72% over the month to 5.0915, close to the low of its recent range.

The Focus 2026 Selic median stayed at 13.75%, while its inflation median edged down 0.03 percentage point.

Official sources

[BCB · Focus](#)

[BCB · Selic / SGS 432](#)

[BCB · Copom](#)

[FRED · DGS2](#)

[B3 · DI1](#)

[FRED · DGS10](#)

[IMF / FRED · PIORECRUSDM](#)

[IMF / FRED · PSUGAISAUSDM](#)

[Reuters · Brazil markets](#)

[BCB · PTAX](#)

[Federal Reserve · FOMC](#)

[FRED · DFEDTARL](#)

[CME FedWatch](#)

[FRED · DFEDTARU](#)

[EIA / FRED · DCOILBRENTU](#)

[IMF / FRED · PSOYBUSDQ](#)

[AP · oil supply shock](#)

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